

TOP 50 CASE STUDIES BY THUNDERSTUDY

Section D Special: Source-Based Question Bank for History Boards



THEME 1 – HARAPPAN CIVILISATION

Case Study 1

Source: Archaeologists found granaries and uniform weight systems in Harappan cities.

Q1. What does this suggest about Harappan economy?

✓ **Surplus production and organised trade**

Q2. Why were weights important?

✓ **Standardisation in trade**

Case Study 2

Source: Harappan seals contained animal figures and unknown script.

Q1. What was the main use of seals?

✓ **Trade and identification**

Q2. Why is Harappan script significant?

✓ **It remains undeciphered**

Case Study 3

Source: Harappans obtained raw materials from distant regions.

Q1. Name one material imported.

✓ **Lapis lazuli / copper**

Q2. What does it show?

✓ **Long-distance trade network**

Case Study 4

Source: Archaeologists reconstructed Harappan diet from animal bones and plant remains.

Q1. What method was used?

✓ **Archaeobotany & zooarchaeology**

Q2. What does it reveal?

✓ **Mixed diet of crops and meat**

Case Study 5

Source: Harappan cities had planned drainage systems.

Q1. What does it indicate?

✓ Advanced urban planning

Q2. Why is it unique?

✓ Covered drainage and sanitation

THEME 2 – BUDDHISM & JAINISM

Case Study 6

Source: Buddha advised Sigala on duties towards family and servants.

Q1. Which text contains this teaching?

✓ Sutta Pitaka

Q2. What was Buddha promoting?

✓ Moral and ethical social behaviour

Case Study 7

Source: Ashoka appointed Dhamma Mahamattas.

Q1. What was their duty?

✓ Spread Dhamma

Q2. Why were they appointed?

✓ Promote moral governance

Case Study 8

Source: Stupas were constructed to house relics.

Q1. Which religion built stupas?

✓ Buddhism

Q2. Name a famous stupa.

✓ Sanchi Stupa

Case Study 9

Source: Jainism believed in strict non-violence.

Q1. What doctrine influenced rebirth?

✓ Karma

Q2. Main aim of Jainism?

✓ Liberation (moksha)

Case Study 10

Source: Buddhist monasteries were built along trade routes.

Q1. Why along trade routes?

✓ Receive patronage and donations

Q2. Who supported monasteries?

✓ Traders and rulers

THEME 3 – BHAKTI & SUFI TRADITIONS

Case Study 11

Source: Guru Nanak rejected caste and ritualism.

Q1. Which Bhakti form did he follow?

✓ Nirguna Bhakti

Q2. Main teaching?

✓ Equality and devotion to one God

Case Study 12

Source: Sufi saints welcomed people of all religions.

Q1. What place became centre of Sufi worship?

✓ Dargah

Q2. Example of famous dargah?

✓ Fatehpur Sikri (Salim Chisti)

Case Study 13

Source: Bhakti saints composed devotional poetry in local languages.

Q1. Why use local language?

✓ Reach common people

Q2. Result of this practice?

✓ Spread of devotional movements

Case Study 14

Source: Virashaiva movement criticised caste hierarchy.

Q1. Where did it originate?

✓ Karnataka

Q2. Whom did they worship?

✓ Shiva

Case Study 15

Source: Saguna and Nirguna were two devotional traditions.

Q1. Saguna means?

✓ God with form

Q2. Nirguna means?

✓ Formless God



THEME 4 – MUGHAL & VIJAYANAGAR

Case Study 16

Source: Ain-i-Akbari records Mughal administration.

Q1. Who wrote it?

✓ Abul Fazl

Q2. Importance?

✓ Source of agrarian history

Case Study 17

Source: Mansabdari system organised Mughal military.

Q1. What was mansab?

✓ Rank and salary

Q2. Who introduced it?

✓ Akbar

Case Study 18

Source: Vijayanagar had strong fortifications.

Q1. Purpose of fortification?

✓ Defence and political strength

Q2. Capital of Vijayanagar?

✓ Hampi

Case Study 19

Source: Mahanavami Dibba used during royal ceremonies.

Q1. Which empire built it?

✓ Vijayanagar

Q2. Function?

✓ Royal rituals and celebrations

Case Study 20

Source: Ibn Battuta described Delhi Sultanate.

Q1. Who invited him to India?

✓ Muhammad Bin Tughlaq

Q2. His position?

✓ Qazi of Delhi

THEME 5 – MUGHAL RURAL SOCIETY

Case Study 21

Source: Raiyats cultivated land under zamindars.

Q1. Who were raiyats?

✓ Peasants

Q2. Role of zamindars?

✓ Revenue collectors

Case Study 22

Source: Shroffs exchanged coins.

Q1. Who were shroffs?

✓ Money changers

Q2. Why important?

✓ Trade facilitation

Case Study 23

Source: Cash crops called 'Jins-i-Kamil'.

Q1. Example of such crop?

✓ Cotton / Sugarcane

Q2. Why valuable?

✓ High revenue

Case Study 24

Source: Mughal paintings reflected royal power.

Q1. What did paintings show?

✓ Authority of emperor

Q2. Why commissioned?

✓ Political propaganda

Case Study 25

Source: Women of Mughal household influenced politics.

Q1. Example?

✓ Jahanara Begum

Q2. Role?

✓ Patronage and diplomacy

THEME 6 – COLONIAL INDIA

Case Study 26

Source: Permanent Settlement fixed revenue.

Q1. Introduced by whom?

✓ Lord Cornwallis

Q2. Main objective?

✓ Stable British income

Case Study 27

Source: Paharias lived in Rajmahal hills.

Q1. Their livelihood depended on?

✓ Forest resources

Q2. Why conflict with British?

✓ Forest control policies

Case Study 28

Source: British surveys documented Indian resources.

Q1. Example of survey officer?

✓ Francis Buchanan

Q2. Purpose?

✓ Economic exploitation

Case Study 29

Source: Subsidiary Alliance forced Indian rulers to accept British troops.

Q1. Introduced by?

✓ Lord Wellesley

Q2. Result?

✓ Loss of independence

Case Study 30

Source: Doctrine of Lapse annexed princely states.

Q1. Introduced by?

✓ Dalhousie

Q2. Effect?

✓ Expansion of British territory

✂ THEME 7 – REVOLT OF 1857

Case Study 31

Source: Revolt began in Meerut.

Q1. Date of revolt?

✓ 10 May 1857

Q2. Mughal leader of revolt?

✓ Bahadur Shah Zafar

Case Study 32

Source: Rebel proclamations united people.

Q1. Which groups joined revolt?

✓ Soldiers, peasants, rulers

Q2. Why unity occurred?

✓ Anti-British sentiment

Case Study 33

Source: British suppressed revolt using military power.

Q1. One method used?

✓ Brutal punishments

Q2. Result?

✓ End of Mughal rule

Case Study 34

Source: Rani Lakshmibai became symbol of resistance.

Q1. State ruled by her?

✓ Jhansi

Q2. Why famous?

✓ Heroic fight against British

Case Study 35

Source: Awadh called 'nursery of Bengal army'.

Q1. Why?

✓ Large recruitment of soldiers

Q2. Impact in revolt?

✓ Major participation

THEME 8 – NATIONAL MOVEMENT

Case Study 36

Source: Salt Satyagraha challenged salt tax.

Q1. Leader of movement?

✓ Gandhi

Q2. Why salt chosen?

✓ Affected common people

Case Study 37

Source: Swadeshi movement promoted Indian goods.

Q1. Trigger event?

✓ Partition of Bengal

Q2. Leaders involved?

✓ Lal-Bal-Pal

Case Study 38

Source: Quit India Movement demanded immediate independence.

Q1. Year launched?

✓ 1942

Q2. Slogan?

✓ Do or Die

Case Study 39

Source: Non-Cooperation Movement opposed British institutions.

Q1. One method used?

✓ Boycott of schools & courts

Q2. Why withdrawn?

✓ Chauri Chaura incident

Case Study 40

Source: Gandhi-Irwin Pact ended Civil Disobedience.

Q1. Main provision?

✓ Release of political prisoners

Q2. Criticism?

✓ Seen as compromise

THEME 9 – CONSTITUTION MAKING

Case Study 41

Source: Constituent Assembly debated federal structure.

Q1. Three lists created?

✓ Union, State, Concurrent

Q2. Purpose?

✓ Power distribution

Case Study 42

Source: Drafting Committee prepared constitution.

Q1. Chairman?

✓ B.R Ambedkar

Q2. Role?

✓ Draft final constitution

Case Study 43

Source: Objective Resolution laid principles of constitution.

Q1. Proposed by?

✓ Jawaharlal Nehru

Q2. Importance?

✓ Blueprint of constitution

Case Study 44

Source: Assembly debates protected minority rights.

Q1. Why protection necessary?

✓ Social equality

Q2. Outcome?

✓ Fundamental Rights

Case Study 45

Source: National flag adopted by Assembly.

Q1. Colours represent?

✓ Sacrifice, peace, prosperity

Q2. Symbol in centre?

✓ Ashoka Chakra

THEME 10 – HISTORICAL SOURCES

Case Study 46

Source: Inscriptions used to reconstruct history.

Q1. One advantage?

✓ Authentic evidence

Q2. One limitation?

✓ Royal bias

Case Study 47

Source: Coins reveal economic activities.

Q1. Example?

✓ Roman coins in South India

Q2. What do they show?

✓ Trade relations

Case Study 48

Source: Travel accounts described Indian society.

Q1. Example traveller?

✓ Al-Biruni / Ibn Battuta

Q2. Importance?

✓ Foreign perspective

Case Study 49

Source: Paintings used as historical sources.

Q1. What do Mughal paintings depict?

✓ Court life & power

Q2. Why valuable?

✓ Visual evidence

Case Study 50

Source: Epics like Mahabharata shaped cultural memory.

Q1. Was Mahabharata written in one period?

☒ No, over centuries

Q2. Importance?

☒ Social and political insights

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